

OnePlus Open

Has OnePlus perfected the foldable formula?

The foldables landscape in India has seen a massive shift in 2023. Now, OnePlus is launching its debut product in this space with a tall claim – having the most well-thought-out and functional foldable experience. Has it lived up to this? Let's find out in our review.

BUILD AND DESIGN

For me, the OnePlus Open's design is very close to perfect. It is both thinner and lighter than the Z Fold5. Slightly more curved edges could have enhanced the in-hand comfort even more, but for a first-generation design, this is brilliant.

One thing that takes away from what could have been the perfect Fold design is the camera bump. The camera module on the OnePlus Open is quite polarising. It juts out considerably which also makes it rock a lot on a flat surface.

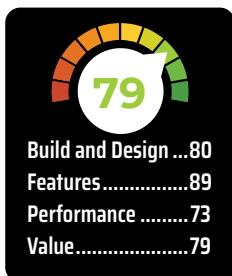
Camera module aside, the phone folds completely flat (always a plus in our books), the buttons are nice and tactile, the alert slider is super convenient, and the fingerprint sensor is quite fast.

DISPLAY(S)

The two things that impressed me the most were the cover screen's aspect ratio and the near-invisible crease. I've had to make a real effort to notice the crease. So, OnePlus' 'Flexion' Hinge is really working wonders. The aspect ratio of the cover screen is also much more user-friendly than that of the Z Fold5. It is more comfortable to use, one-handed operation is easier, and the screen doesn't feel vertically stretched.

The primary display's refresh rate can go down to 1 Hz while the cover display can go down to 10 Hz. Or at least that's what they're supposed to do. When I tested this, I found that the displays were only

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switching between 60 Hz and 120 Hz on Auto. This will obviously mess with battery life. Refresh rate aside, the displays on the OnePlus Open are incredibly bright. I recorded 2,021 nits of peak brightness on Auto Mode under direct sunlight, which is very impressive. HDR content looks nice and vivid and the displays are very sharp. The displays also support 10-bit colour, Dolby Vision, and HDR10+, so you've got all the essentials for a good viewing experience.

CAMERAS

The OnePlus Open focuses heavily on its camera performance. To that end, the company has packed the foldable with an imposing set of triple cameras.

The primary camera takes some stunning shots in daylight and low-light conditions. The colours are close to natural,

the detail is very good, and the dynamic range is decent. There are some occasions when the primary camera overexposes highlights but an update we got midway through reviewing the phone minimised those issues.

Portrait photos come out looking social-media-ready. Some issues need ironing out such as less-than-ideal edge detection and smoothing of face textures but overall, the images look flattering. The 64-megapixel telephoto camera clicks 3x portrait shots that look great; the dynamic range and colour science are very close to the main camera.

The telephoto camera, as a whole, clicks some impressive pictures. You get 3x optical zoom and 6x in-sensor zoom, and honestly, the quality hit at 6x is not bad at all. Then there's the 48-megapixel ultra-wide camera. Like the primary camera, it sometimes overexposes highlight areas, but otherwise, we quite liked the look of the photos.

Finally, while the 20-megapixel and 32-megapixel selfie cameras are capable of clicking decent images, the selfies from the main camera are phenomenal though. So, I see no reason why anyone should use the other two selfie cameras.

PERFORMANCE

On paper, the specifications make it seem like the OnePlus Open could compete with the best flagship phones out there in terms of performance. Unfortunately, it's not 100 per cent true.

I started off by running a bunch of synthetic benchmarks. In most CPU benchmarks, the OnePlus Open stood its ground – it got solid scores in AnTuTu and GeekBench, and despite lagging a bit behind in PCMark Work, the score wasn't too bad. The phone also doesn't throttle too much. In the CPU Throttling Test, the OnePlus Open throttled to only 85 per cent of its peak performance in 15 minutes, which is great.

However, the phone consistently scored low in all GPU tests including 3D Mark WildLife Extreme and all the usual tests we run in GFXBench. Additionally, while using this phone as a daily driver, I also faced some thermal issues. The